SUSE embraces open source NFV

SUSE has joined the Open Platform for the NFV (OPNFV) project, an integrated open source carrier grade platform. The adding on of NFV will enhance SUSE's performance, and help in OpenStack based cloud infrastructure and Ceph based software defined storage. SUSE is enhancing its mission-critical computing capabilities.

OpenStack cloud and enterprise storage spaces as well as carrier grade technology are part of OPNFV, which will accelerate the development of the NFV platform not just for the partners but also for the consumers.

This change will take place on SUSE Linux Enterprise, SUSE OpenStack and SUSE Enterprise storage, which will incorporate NFV capabilities to deliver their next generation services.

Interest in software defined infrastructure is growing rapidly, and most of the telecom service providers see the virtualisation of network functions as an important aspect of software infrastructure.

Hashcat is now open source

The major password recovery tool used by penetration testers and forensic scientists worldwide is now available under an open source licence. These tools are CPU and GPU based, and are now available on multiple platforms. An MIT licence allows for the integration of Hashcat with many Linux distributions.

It will now be easier to integrate the external libraries, although this is not required at the moment. The code for Hashcat and oclHashcat is available on the code repository website, GitHub.

Also, there is news of combining Hashcat and oclHashcat into one project called just Hashcat. Now, after going open source, developers can compile kernels using Apple protocols; hence, OS X support for oclHashcat is now a possibility.

Although this has been a very important change, it will take some time to take shape.

Adobe's security update for Linux Flash player

In spite of being shunned by many players on the Internet, it is still difficult to get rid of Flash player, which makes security issues an ongoing concern. Adobe has abandoned development of Flash and it seems that Linux has followed suit. The Flash player in Linux will stay dormant at the stage of 11.x until it is declared dead. The sole reason for the delay in removing Flash is the number of security issues, which have not been fixed by Adobe. This has made Flash one of the slowest and most difficult to deal with. It is unclear why Adobe is not willing to adopt a more alert development approach.

Vulnerabilities in Linux are closed as soon as they are found, although all the vulnerabilities are classified which means there is no clue about the real issue. While the recent update from Adobe will address critical vulnerabilities that could potentially allow the attacker to control a system, Adobe wrote in the security notice that none of these vulnerabilities have been exploited till now.

Linux Kernel 4.3.1 released, with several ARM, x86 improvements

Developer Greg Kroah-Hartman has announced the first maintenance release of Linux kernel version 4.3.1, and users of Linux 4.3 kernel are advised to update to it. The release comes after about a month since the release of Linux kernel 4.3. Linux lovers were getting impatient about the maintenance releases, but now the wait is over. The best part is that the latest Linux release comes with a host of interesting features. Going by the numbers, about 136 files have been changed, with 1,224 insertions and 438 deletions.

The updated 4.3.y Git tree can be found at: git://git.kernel.org/pub/scm/linux/kernel/git/stable/linux-stable. git linux-4.3.y and can be browsed at the normal kernel.org git Web browser: http://git.kernel.org/?p=linux/kernel/git/stable/linux-stable.git;a=summary.

Linux 4.3.1 brings in a host of improvements in ARM, x86, s390, MIPS and ARM64 (AArch64) hardware architectures. Along with these, it also offers several networking updates, particularly focusing on Bluetooth, IPv6, IPv4, mac80211, NFC, TIPC (Transparent Inter-Process Communication) and wireless. It also offers USB sound driver improvements.

Besides, the Linux kernel 4.3.1 comes with a good number of driver updates for things including Bluetooth, CLK, MFD, NFC, PINCTRL, TTY, USB, Xen and networking (mostly wireless and Ethernet). The makers of the Linux kernel have also introduced some under-the-hood improvements to make it more stable and reliable.